MILITARY SPECIFICATION

PACKAGING OF SPECIAL OPERATIONS FORCES MOUNTAINEERING EQUIPMENT (SOFME) SET

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This document covers the preservation, packing and marking for one complete Special Operations Forces Mountaineering Equipment (SOFME) Set.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents shall be those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

A-A-203 - Paper, Kraft, Untreated
A-A-50041 - Snap Link, Mountain Piton, Locking and Nonlocking
A-A-50096 - Hammer, Rock and Ice
A-A-50097 - Pulley, Mountain, Rescue

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC PACK

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A-A-50098 - Stopper, Hexagon, Irregular
A-A-50106 - Stopper, Wired, Wedged
A-A-50111 - Piton, Mountain, Flat
A-A-50112 - Piton, Mountain, Angle
A-A-50113 - Piton, Ice
A-A-50114 - Piton, Mountain, Knifeblade, Offset
A-A-50115 - Piton, Mountain, Cliffhanger
A-A-50116 - Axe, Ice
A-A-50117 - Crampons, Hinged
A-A-50118 - Straps, Crampon
A-A-50119 - Anchor, Snow, Wired
A-A-50120 - Harness, Climbing, Full-Body
A-A-50121 - Protector, Crampon
A-A-50125 - Descender, Figure-8
A-A-50127 - Ascender, Cam Action
A-A-50139 - Rope, Kernmantle
PPP-B-636 - Box, Shipping, Fiberboard

MILITARY

MIL-R-1688 - Rope, Nylon, Climbing Type
MIL-L-35078 - Loads, Unit: Preparation of Semiperishable Subsistence Items; Clothing, Personal Equipment and Equipage; General Specification For
MIL-W-5625 - Webbing, Textile, Nylon, Tubular

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-147 - Palletized Unit Loads
MIL-STD-731 - Quality of Wood Members for Containers and Pallets

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DOD adopted shall be those listed in the issue of the DODISS specified in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS shall be the issues of the nongovernment documents which are current on the date of the solicitation.

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

D 3951 - Standard Practice for Commercial Packaging

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103-1187.)

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(Nongovernment standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations which prepare or which distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein, the text of this specification shall take precedence. Nothing in this specification, however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials. Materials shall conform to applicable documents and requirements specified herein.

3.2 Preservation. Items shall be preserved as specified in the item documents.

3.3 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or Commerical, as specified (see 6.2).

3.3.1 Level A packing. Items preserved as specified in 3.2 shall be packed in the quantities specified in table I in a fiberboard box conforming to style RSC-L, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The inside of each box shall be fitted with a box liner conforming to type CF, class weather-resistant, variety DW, grade V15c of PPP-B-636. Voids in the shipping container shall be filled with crumpled kraft paper conforming to A-A-203. Each box shall be closed in accordance with method III, waterproofed in accordance with method V, and reinforced as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636. Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified (see 6.2). Strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

TABLE I. Container contents

Container	Quantity	Item Description	Specification
Box 1	12 each	Harness, Climbing	A-A-50120
	6 each	Stopper, Wired, Wedge, Size I	A-A-50106
	6 each	Stopper, Wired, Wedge, Size II	A-A-50106
	6 each	Stopper, Wired, Wedge, Size III	A-A-50106
	6 each	Stopper, Wired, Wedge, Size IV	A-A-50106
	6 each	Stopper, Wired, Wedge,	

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TABLE I. Container contents (cont'd)

Container	Quantity	Item Description	Specification
		Size V	A-A-50106
	6 each	Stopper, Wired, Wedge, Size VI	A-A-50106
	6 each	Stopper, Wired, Wedge, Size VII	A-A-50106
	6 each	Stopper, Wired, Wedge, Size VIII	A-A-50106
	2 each	Rope, Nylon, Climbing Type, 150 Foot length	MIL-R-1688
Box 2	12 each	Axe, Ice	A-A-50116
	6 each	Piton Mountain Flat Type I	A-A-50111
	6 each	Piton Mountain Flat Type II	A-A-50111
	6 each	Piton Mountain Flat Type III	A-A-50111
	8 each	Piton Mountain Flat Type IV	A-A-50111
	12 each	Piton Mountain Knife Blade Offset	A-A-50114
	6 each	Piton Mountain Angle Type I	A-A-50112
	6 each	Piton Mountain Angle Type II	A-A-50112
	6 each	Piton Mountain Angle Type III	A-A-50112
	4 each	Piton Mountain Cliffhanger	A-A-50115
	8 each	Piton Ice Type I	A-A-50113
	8 each	Piton Ice Type II	A-A-50113
Box 3	12 each	Hammer Rock and Ice	A-A-50096
	12 pair	Crampons, Hinged	A-A-50117
	14 pair	Straps, Crampon	A-A-50118
	12 pair	Protectors, Crampon	A-A-50121

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TABLE I. Container contents (cont'd)

Container	Quantity	Item Description	Specification
Box 4	1 roll	Rope Kernmantle Type I 150 Feet Long	A-A-50139
	1 roll	Rope Kernmantle Type II 150 Feet Long	A-A-50139
	1 roll	Rope Kernmantle Type III 150 Feet Long	A-A-50139
	12 each	Snap Link, Mountain Piton Type II	A-A-50041
	60 each	Snap Link, Mountain Piton Type III	A-A-50041
	6 each	Stopper, Hexagon, Irregular Size I	A-A-50098
	6 each	Stopper, Hexagon, Irregular Size IIB	A-A-50098
Box 5	4 each	Rope Kernmantle Type IV 165 Feet Long	A-A-50139
	8 each	Pulley, Mountain Rescue	A-A-50097
	1 roll	Webbing, Textile Nylon Tubular 9/16" wide x 75 feet long color OD-7	MIL-W-5625
	1 roll	Webbing, Textile Nylon Tubular 1" wide x 75 feet long color OD-7	MIL-W-5625
	2 each	Anchor snow wired size 1	A-A-50119
	2 each	Anchor snow wired size 2	A-A-50119
Box 6	4 each	Rope Kernmantle Type IV 165 Feet Long	A-A-50139
	8 pair	Ascenders, Cam Action	A-A-50127
	12 pair	Descender, Figure 8	A-A-50125

3.3.2 Level B packing. Items preserved as specified in 3.2 shall be packed in the quantities specified in table I in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC-L, type CF (variety SW) or SF, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The inside of each shipping container shall be fitted with a box liner conforming to type CF, variety DW, grade 200 of PPP-B-636. Voids in the shipping container shall be filled with crumpled kraft paper conforming to A-A-203.

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3.3.2.1 Weather-resistant fiberboard containers. When specified (see 6.2), the shipping container shall be grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard box fabricated in accordance with PPP-B-636, and closed in accordance with method III, as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636.

3.3.3 Commerical packing. Items preserved as specified in 3.2 shall be packed in accordance with ASTM D-3951.

3.4 Palletization. When specified (see 6.2), items packed as specified in 3.3.1 and 3.3.2, shall be palletized on a 4-way entry pallet in accordance with load type Ia of MIL-STD-147. Pallet type shall be type I (4-way entry), type IV or type V in accordance with MIL-STD-147. Pallets shall be fabricated from wood groups I, II, III, or IV of MIL-STD-731. Each prepared load shall be bonded with primary and secondary straps in accordance with bonding means K and L, or film bonding means O or P.

3.5 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order, shipping containers and palletized unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 or ASTM D-3951, as applicable.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this document where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items must meet all requirements of section 3. The inspection set forth in this document shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirement in the document shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of assuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling in quality conformance does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to acceptance of defective material.

4.2 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.2.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this document or applicable purchase document.

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4.2.3 Packaging examination. The fully packaged end items shall be examined for the defects listed below. The lot size shall be expressed in units of shipping containers. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully packaged. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5.

Examine	Defect
Marking (exterior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing, damaged, or not as specified.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as incomplete sealing or closure of flap, improper taping, loose strapping, or inadequate stapling. Bulged or distorted container.
Content	Number of items per shipping container is more or less than required.

4.2.4 Palletization examination. The fully packaged and palletized end items shall be examined for the defects listed below. The lot size shall be expressed in units of palletized unit loads. The sample unit shall be one palletized unit load, fully packaged. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 6.5.

Examine	Defect
Finished dimensions	Length, width, or height exceeds specified maximum requirement.
Palletization	Load not bonded as specified.
Weight	Exceeds maximum load limits.
Marking	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size location, sequence, or method of application.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be as specified herein.

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6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The packaging requirements specified are intended for use in packaging the SOFME Set.

6.2 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Selection of applicable levels of packing (see 3.3).
b. Type and class of unit load required (see 3.3.1).
c. When weather-resistant grade fiberboard shipping containers are required for level B packing (see 3.3.2.1).
d. When palletization is required (see 3.4).

6.3 Subject term (key word) listing.

a. Packaging
b. SOFME set

Custodians:

Army - GL

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. PACK-A348

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-P-44336(GL)	Packaging of Special Operations Forces Mountaineering Equipment (SOFME) Set

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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NATICK/OP-1, Feb 86

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